30th Sunday in Ordinary Time
25th October 2026

One Question, One Answer: Two Sides, Same Coin

Another week, another trap. Last Sunday they came with a coin. This week a lawyer comes with a question: which commandment is the greatest?

Jesus does not hesitate. Love the Lord your God with all your heart, all your soul, all your mind. Then, though nobody asked, he adds a second and says it is like the first: love your neighbour as yourself. On these two hang the whole Law and the Prophets.

Think back to that coin. Every coin has two sides, heads and tails, but nobody has ever spent one side of a coin. It is one piece of metal or it is nothing. That is what Jesus is saying about love. Love of God is one side. Love of neighbour is the other. Try to separate them and you are left holding something worthless. You cannot love the God you have never seen while ignoring the neighbour you see every day. And you cannot truly love the neighbour without the God whose image that neighbour bears.

That is the link. Last week Jesus asked whose image was on the coin. We said that we bear God's image. So does the stranger, the widow, the orphan, the man whose cloak is held in pledge. The first reading is blunt about it: give the cloak back by sunset, because it is all he has to sleep in. God's compassion lands in practical places, in coins and cloaks.

St Paul tells the Thessalonians that their faith is known everywhere. Not because of their preaching, but because people saw how they lived. Their faith had two sides, but it was never two-faced. Like the coin, it was solid and the same.

Loving God is what we do in Church. Loving neighbour is how the world knows we mean it. Two sides. Same coin. Spend it well.

Fr Sean

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: ***Melmount:*** £2745.00; ***Sion Mills*****:** £1370.00. Thank you.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 25 October after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm. The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Annual Service for the Dead The Annual Service in remembrance of deceased members of our families and parish will take place on Sunday 15 November at 4.00pm in St. Mary's Church, Melmount and at 6.00pm in St. Theresa's Church, Sion Mills. Families who have suffered a bereavement since November 2025 are asked to nominate a representative to carry a candle to the altar in commemoration of their dead. *(Candles will be provided).*

Legion of Mary Rosary at the Mass Rock, Tulacorr Heights tomorrow Monday 26 October at 12 noon.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism
Darragh Frankie McCay

May they Rest in Peace
Deaths
Anthony Patton, 1 Hazel Gardens
Marie McNulty, 32 Millhaven
Lisa Kelly, 103 Beech Mount Village
Marie McNally, 61 Carrick Strand
Maureen McCrossan, 3 Innisfree Gardens
Rosemary Donnell, Castlederg
Anne O'Donnell, Coolatee, Lifford

Anniversaries
Seamus McLaughlin, Kieran Doherty, Pam McLaughlin
Noel McCrory, Patsy Kennedy, Martin McElwee
Deirdre Conway, Kitty McLaughlin, Kathleen Moss
George McGinley, Pat Nugent, Damien McClay
Charlie Flanagan, Maybid Doherty, Edie McDermott
Mamie McNulty, Noreen Doherty, Derek Fletcher
Mary McLaughlin, Gregory Forbes, Philomen Murray
William McLaughlin, Tony Gillespie, Charlie Neeson
Billie Hamilton